Ans. (b): At the United Nations Sustainable Summit on 25 September 2015, world leaders adopted the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development which includes a set of 17 sustainable development goals (SDGS) to end poverty, fight inequality and injustice and tackle climate change by 2030. The history of the SDGS can be traced to 1972 when governments met under the auspices of the United Nations Human and Environment Conference. The 'Club of Rome' is a global think tank that deals with a range of international political issues.

66. The term 'Intended Nationally Determined Contribution' is sometimes seen in the news in the context of :

(a) Pledges made by the European countries to rehabilitate refugees from the war-affected Middle East.
(b) Plan of action outlined by the countries of the world to combat climate changes.
(c) Capital contributed by the member countries in the establishment of Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank .
(d) Plan of action outlined by the countries of the world regarding Sustainable Development Goals.

Ans. (b) : Countries across the globe adopted the International Climate Agreement at the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), Conference of the Parties (COP-21) in Paris 2015.
Under the agreement, countries publicly outlined what post-2020 climate actions they intended to take under the new international agreement, known as their Intended Nationally Determined Contributions (INDSCs), largely determine whether the world achieves the long-term goals of the Paris Agreement to hold the increase in global average temperature to below 2ºC, to peruse efforts to limit the increase to 1.5ºC and to achieve net- zero emissions in the second half of this century.

67. What is/are the importance /importances of the 'United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification' ?

1. It aims to promote effective action through innovative national programmes and supportive international programmes and supportive inter-national partnerships.
2. It has a special / particular focus on South Asia and North Africa regions, and its secretariat facilitates the allocation of major portion of financial resources to these regions.
3. It is committed to bottom-up approach, encouraging the participation of local people in combating the desertification.

Select the correct answer using, the code given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD) established in 1994 is the sole legally binding international agreement linking environment and development to sustainable land management.
Though desertification affects Africa the most, where two-thirds of the continent is desert or drylands in Africa, United States, Latin America and the Caribbean have a high percentage of degraded lands. The UNCCD is particularly committed to a bottom-up approach encouraging the participation of local people in combating desertification and land degradation. The UNCCD secretariat facilitates cooperation between developed and developing countries, particularly around knowledge and technology transfer for sustainable land management.

68. In which of the following regions of India are you most likely to come across the 'Great Indian Hornbill' in its natural habitat ?

(a) Sand deserts of northwest India
(b) Higher Himalayas of Jammu and Kashmir
(c) Salt marshes of western Gujarat
(d) Western Ghats

Ans. (d): Great Hornbills are found in three separate areas in south Asia, in the Western Ghats, the Himalayans foothills in Uttarakhand to south Nepal and Bhutan, and north-east India.
They occur in primary evergreen and moist deciduous forest mainly in lowland forests, but they can be found upto 2000 meters in some areas.
All other options except from (d) can thus be easily eliminated.

69. Which of the following are the key features of 'National Ganga River Basin Authority (NGRBA)' ?

1. River basin is the unit of planning and management.
2. It spearheads the river conservation efforts at the national level.
3. One of the Chief Ministers of the State through which the Ganga flows becomes the Chairman of NGRBA on rotation basis .

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a) : The Central Government, by a notification dated 20.02.2009, has set up the National Ganga River Basin Authority (NGRBA) as an empowered planning financing, monitoring and coordinating authority for the Ganga River, in the exercise of the powers conferred under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986. The prime minister is the ex-officio chairperson of the Authority, and it has as its members the union ministers concerned and the chief ministers of states through which Ganga flows, viz, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand and West Bengal, among others. The objective of the Authority is to ensure effective abatement of pollution and conservation of the river Ganga by adopting a holistic approach with the river basin as the unit of planning. The functions of the Authority include all measures necessary for planning and execution of programmes for abatement of pollution in the Ganga in keeping with sustainable development needs.

- National Ganga River Basin Authority (NGRBA) established in 2009 and mandated to take up regulatory and developmental functions with sustainability needs for effective abatement of pollution and conservation of the river Ganga by adopting a river basin approach for comprehensive planning and management.
- River basin is the unit of planning and management. This is an internationally accepted strategy for integrated management of rivers. NGRBA will spearhead river conservation efforts at the national level and implementation at the state level will be by the state Agencies and Urban Local Bodies.

70. The FAO accords the status of 'Globally Important Agricultural Heritage Systems (GIAHS)' to traditional agricultural systems. What is the overall goal of this initiative-

1. To provide modern technology, training in modern farming methods and financial support of local communities of identified GIAHS so as to greatly enhance their agricultural productivity.
2. To identify and safeguard eco-friendly traditional farm practices and their associated landscapes, agricultural biodiversity and knowledge systems of the local communities.
3. To provide Geographical Indication status to all the varieties of agricultural produce in such identified GIAHS.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): Statement (1) In order to safeguard and support the world's agricultural heritage systems, in 2002, FAO started an initiative for the dynamic conservation of the Globally Important Agricultural Heritage System (GIAHS). So, clearly, modern practices wouldn't be relevant to the initiative (1) is incorrect.
Statement (2) : The initative intends to safeguard the social, cultural, economic and environmental goods and services of these heritage systems. So, (2) is correct.
Statement (3) : There is no such provision. GI is accorded to products from a certain origin (e.g. Hyderabadi Biryani) and not to traditional agricultural systems.

71. Consider the following pairs :

Terms sometimes seen In the news	**Their origin**
1. Annex-I Countries	Cartagena Protocol
2. Certified Emissions Reductions	Nagoya Protocol
3. Clean Development Mechanism	Kyoto Protocol

Which of the pairs given above is /are correctly matched?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : The Clean Development Mechanism (CDM), created multilaterally under the UNFCCC is one of the mitigation instruments under the Kyoto Protocol. The CDM, defined in Article 12 of the protocol, allows a country with an emission-reduction as an emission-limitation commitment under the Kyoto Protocol (Annex B party) to implement on the emission-reduction project in developing countries. Such projects can earn saleable certified emission reduction (CER credits), each equivalent to one time of CO_2, which can be counted towards meeting Kyoto targets.
Annex -I Countries are parties to the Kyoto Protocol.

72. Which of the following best described/describe the aim of 'Green India Mission' of the Government of India ?

1. Incorporating environmental benefits and costs into the Union and State Budgets thereby implementing the 'green accounting'.
2. Launching the second green revolution to enhance agricultural output so as to ensure food security to one and all in the future.
3. Restoring and enhancing forest cover and responding to climate change by a combination of adaptation and mitigation measures.